

# BOÖTES

## THE HERDSMAN

A DISTINCTIVE KITE-SHAPED PATTERN IN THE NORTHERN SKY, BOÖTES IS HOME TO ARCTURUS, ONE OF THE BRIGHTEST AND CLOSEST STARS TO US.

A large constellation, Boötes extends from Draco and Ursa Major in the north to Virgo in the south. Myths differ about what exactly Boötes represents but he is often taken to be a herdsman who is driving away two bears—represented by the constellations Ursa Major and Ursa Minor—with the aid of his dogs, represented by the adjacent constellation Canes Venatici. Boötes' brightest star is Arcturus, which is "bear guard" or "bear keeper" in Greek. It is the brightest star north of the celestial equator. Boötes is also noted for its double stars. The best is Izar, one of the most beautiful doubles in the sky. The Quadrantid meteor shower, named after Quadrans, an obsolete constellation that once took up part of Boötes, radiates from this area of sky every January.

**Arcturus emits over 100 times more energy than the Sun even though it is only slightly more massive**

